

Empower to Employ 2026 — Data Challenge Pack

Challenge Theme: Data

Challenge Title

How can Bupa use data to create more personalised and valuable health experiences, while building a trusted value exchange that encourages customers to share more about their needs and preferences?

Theme or Focus Area

This challenge focuses on how Bupa can use customer data more effectively to better understand individual needs and create health experiences that feel more relevant, timely and valuable.

Bupa interacts with customers across health insurance, health services and digital channels. These interactions can create useful data signals about customer needs, preferences, behaviours and engagement.

However, effective personalisation is not simply about collecting more data. Customers need to understand why their information is being used, what value they receive in return, and how they can remain in control of their information.

Teams should explore how Bupa could:

- Make better use of existing customer and engagement data to understand customer needs and preferences.
- Identify where additional information could meaningfully improve the customer health experience.
- Create a clear and trusted value exchange that gives customers a reason to voluntarily share relevant information.
- Deliver personalisation in a way that feels useful and supportive rather than intrusive.
- Build customer confidence through transparency, consent and appropriate use of data.

Bupa has a broader health ecosystem across health insurance and health services, including dental, optical, health centres, mental health and wellbeing services, health programs, telehealth and digital health services such as **Blua**.

The opportunity is to consider how data from different customer interactions could help create a more connected and relevant health experience.

- [Blua Australia](#)

- [Bupa Digital Healthcare — Blua](#)

What's prompting this challenge?

Customers increasingly expect organisations to provide experiences that are relevant to their individual needs and circumstances.

Bupa already has access to a range of customer, product, service and engagement information. However, the information available may not always provide a complete understanding of what a customer needs, what matters to them, or what health support may be most relevant at a particular point in time.

At the same time, customers are increasingly aware of how organisations collect and use their personal information.

This creates two connected challenges for Bupa:

- **How can Bupa create greater value from the data it already has?**
- **How can Bupa create enough value and trust for customers to voluntarily share additional information that could enable better personalisation?**

The challenge is therefore not simply to collect more information, but to determine what data is genuinely useful, how it can improve the customer experience, and what meaningful value customers receive in return.

Bupa wants to provide more personalised health experiences while maintaining customer trust and responsible use of data.

Data Context

To this challenge, teams should not assume unrestricted access to identifiable customer data.

Teams may consider how different categories of data could contribute to understanding customer needs, including:

- Customer and membership information
- Product and cover information
- Service interactions
- Digital engagement
- Customer service interactions
- Preferences and consent
- Aggregated demographic or location information

- Publicly available health and demographic data

Teams should consider not only what data could be useful, but also:

- Why the data is needed
- What additional insight it provides
- Whether the customer would reasonably expect it to be used in that way
- What customer benefit is created in return

Useful public data and research sources may include:

- [Australian Bureau of Statistics](#)
- [Australian Institute of Health and Welfare](#)
- [APRA — Quarterly Private Health Insurance Statistics](#)
- [PrivateHealth.gov.au](#)

What's the impact to Bupa's business or customers if this improves?

Customer impact

- More relevant and timely health experiences
- Better understanding of available health services and support
- Easier navigation across Bupa's broader health ecosystem
- Greater transparency and control over how personal information is used
- A clearer benefit from sharing relevant needs and preferences with Bupa
- Increased trust in how Bupa uses customer information

Business impact

- Stronger customer engagement and loyalty
- Better understanding of customer needs and preferences
- More effective personalisation across Bupa services and channels
- Stronger connections across health insurance and health services
- Increased customer trust in Bupa's use of data
- A stronger foundation for future data-led health experiences
- Stronger consumer understanding of health and wellbeing choices

What are the known constraints or non-negotiables?

Any use of customer or health data must be designed responsibly.

Teams should consider:

- Privacy compliance
- Data security
- Ethical use of data
- Clear customer benefit
- Transparency
- Consent and customer control
- Voluntary participation where additional information is collected
- Data minimisation
- Avoiding discriminatory or unfair outcomes
- Appropriate use of sensitive information
- Explainable use of data and recommendations
- Appropriate human oversight where required

Teams should not assume unrestricted access to identifiable customer information, and any proposed use of data should have a clear and legitimate customer benefit.

Relevant references include:

- [Privacy Act 1988](#)
- [OAIC — Health and Medical Information](#)
- [Bupa Information Handling Policy](#)

These considerations are not intended to limit innovation, but to ensure ideas are grounded in real-world trust, responsibility and feasibility.

What should teams consider?

Rather than prescribing a particular solution, teams should consider:

The customer problem

What customer need or experience could be improved through better use of data?

The data opportunity

What information would help Bupa better understand or respond to that need?

The value exchange

If additional customer information is required, why would a customer choose to share it?

Trust and responsibility

How would the approach maintain transparency, consent and customer control?

Impact

How would the team determine whether the experience creates meaningful value for both customers and Bupa?

Who could teams speak to for insight or feedback?

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